AUTOMAIT

Christmas trading-hours checklist

For Australian small businesses closing or cutting hours over Christmas 2026 and New Year 2027.
Fill in your dates, then tick each box.

Your dates

Last trading day _____ **Back open on** _____ **Last quotes / orders by** _____

Final invoices sent by _____ **Urgent contact** _____

3–4 weeks before · late November

- [ ] Pick your closing and reopening dates (check your state's holidays)
- [ ] Set a last date for quotes, bookings and orders
- [ ] Ask suppliers for their cut-off and reopening dates; place final orders
- [ ] Confirm staff leave and rosters; check public holiday pay at fairwork.gov.au
- [ ] Pick a final invoice date and chase anything overdue

1–2 weeks before · early December

- [ ] Google Business Profile: add special hours for every closed or changed day
- [ ] Website: add a holiday-hours banner with your closed and reopen dates
- [ ] Socials: post your dates and pin the post (Facebook, Instagram)
- [ ] Update hours on Apple Maps, directories and booking or delivery apps
- [ ] Tell regular customers by email or SMS (if it promotes anything: only people who've agreed or would expect it, say who you are, include an opt-out)
- [ ] Print and put up your door or window sign

Your last day · before you lock up

- [ ] Send your final invoices
- [ ] Turn on your email auto-reply
- [ ] Record your holiday voicemail message
- [ ] Set call forwarding for urgent calls (only if you're offering it)
- [ ] Back up files; secure the premises and equipment

Back in January · first day open

- [ ] Turn off the auto-reply; restore your normal voicemail
- [ ] Check Google and your website show normal hours; remove the banner
- [ ] Post a short 'we're open again' note (email or SMS it only to customers who've agreed to hear from you)
- [ ] Take down the door sign

Quick wording

Email auto-reply
“Thanks for your email. [Business name] is closed from [closing date] and back on [reopening date]. We'll reply when we're back. For anything urgent, call [number].”

Voicemail
“Hi, you've reached [business name]. We're closed for the holidays until [reopening date]. Leave your name and number and we'll call you back when we reopen.”

Want it written for you? AUTOMAIT's Christmas closure packs have ready-to-fill door signs plus email, SMS, auto-reply and voicemail wording: automait.au/shop

Public holidays 2026–27

Thu 24 Dec	**Christmas Eve, part-day**	From 7 pm in NT and SA; from 6 pm in QLD
Fri 25 Dec	**Christmas Day**	All states and territories
Sat 26 Dec	**Boxing Day**	All except SA (Proclamation Day instead) and TAS (not a public holiday)
Mon 28 Dec	**Additional public holiday**	All states and territories (in TAS this is Boxing Day)
Thu 31 Dec	**New Year's Eve, part-day**	From 7 pm in NT and SA
Fri 1 Jan 2027	**New Year's Day**	All states and territories
Tue 26 Jan 2027	**Australia Day**	All states and territories

Source: Fair Work Ombudsman 2026 and 2027 public holiday pages, checked 10 November 2026. Local and regional holidays can differ, so check your state at fairwork.gov.au.

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General information only, not legal, HR or tax advice.
Check dates for your state.